

Arun Topwal

IT Service Management & Delivery Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned IT Service Management and IT Service Delivery Leader with extensive experience in ITIL and ITSM governance processes across global BFSI Enterprises. Proven track record managing end-to-end Change, Problem & Incident Management, ServiceNow platform and CMDB frameworks, Command Centre, Monitoring and Observability, Vendor relationship management, KPI and SLA metrics, Agentic AI and Automation strategy, IT audits. Adept at driving operational excellence and establishing robust governance and IT Risk management models. Trusted partner to global Executive stakeholders and executive leadership, consistently delivering strategic value through process innovation & continuous improvement

Ex: Barclays, Nomura, Fidelity Investments

CORE SKILLS

- IT Service Management (ITSM) Leadership
- ITIL Governance & Strategy
- Global IT Service Delivery
- ServiceNow Platform Ownership and Transformations
- IT Change & Release Management
- Major Incidents and Problem Management
- Capacity Planning & Cost Optimization
- Monitoring and Observability
- Agentic AI Strategy and Automation
- Executive Stakeholder Management
- IT Risk, Audit and Compliance
- Vendor Management & Governance
- SLA and KPI Governance
- Leadership & Team Development

KEY HIGHLIGHTS & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Chairman's Share Award** for High Performance and Director's Award for Innovation at Fidelity.
- **Led Agentic AI proof-of-concept** and business case, demonstrating a projected **\$20.4M ROI in savings**.
- **Achieved 100% audit readiness** by formalizing CAB governance at AllianceBernstein.
- **Reduced MTTR by 25%** by embedding strict SLAs into the Major Incident Management process.
- **Drove 98% CMDB compliance** by introducing a mandatory bi-annual recertification at AllianceBernstein.
- **Recognized by Barclays MD** for successfully **managing an IT audit** end to end.
- Received Barclays BU Director Appreciation for automation initiatives, **saving £600K and 200 person-hours**.
- **Delivered \$455K in cost savings** on software licenses through optimization strategies at Barclays.
- **Designed Incident Management** service offerings at Incedo, **securing \$2M in IT service contracts**.
- Enhanced Change Management process at Nomura, **saved 120 person-hours monthly and improving SLAs by 50%**.

CERTIFICATIONS

- ITIL Intermediate Level Certified (Service Operations)
- ITIL Problem Analyst Certified
- PMP Trained IT Project Manager
- Certified ServiceNow Administrator

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vice President, Global IT Service Delivery

AllianceBernstein | Pune, India

(Jun 2025 – Present)

- Led ITSM core processes across Change Management, Problem, Major Incidents & ServiceNow Product Ownership, driving service performance, capacity planning & proactive monitoring.
- Served as strategic ServiceNow product owner, driving platform vision, backlog prioritization & delivery of out-of-the-box workflows to optimize enterprise IT service operations and platform ROI.
- Host CABs, Managed Major Incidents, Root Cause Analysis (RCA) & mitigation steps to minimize service disruptions.
- Transformed Change Management governance to sharpen risk assessment and decision-making.
- Managed Operational Risk registers & control attestations, ensuring strict adherence to cyber, audit & regulatory standards.
- Drove digital transformation by running POC of Agentic AI and ServiceNow Integration with Slack and Genesys for ITSD faster resolution and improved customer service
- Overhauled Problem Management to ITIL standards, establishing strict SLAs to drive MTTR reduction.
- Engaged senior executive stakeholders to drive effective IT governance and strategic alignment.
- Optimized operational costs and resource usage while maintaining high service quality and customer satisfaction.
- Led a POC with the ServiceNow team to onboard ITOM Discovery for enhanced visibility.
- Presented monthly ITSM performance metrics and analytics to the Head of Technology.
- Conducted ITSM awareness workshops for the leadership team under the CTO.
- Held people management responsibility across the Global IT Service Management team.

Senior Technical Manager, IT Service Delivery

Cetera Financial Group | Gurgaon, India

(Apr 2024 – Jan 2025)

- Led IT Change, Problem & Event (Monitoring) Management; oversaw managed service delivery, consistently meeting all client SLAs and contractual obligations.
- Led Incident Management bridges, creating war rooms for Major Incidents, chaired Problem Management reviews & CAB meetings.
- Led a globally distributed 24x7x365 Technology Global Command Centre supporting critical business services.
- Leveraged IBM Netcool, Splunk, New Relic etc. for effective monitoring and alerting, introducing strategic configuration changes to improve monitoring coverage and significantly reduce Major Incidents.
- Identified and introduced tools to enhance monitoring based on industry best practices and organizational needs.
- Ran a POC for Proactive monitoring with Datadog to reduce incidents.
- Reviewed dashboards and KPI analysis in weekly status reports and quarterly business reviews with clients.
- Partnered with presales and program management teams to optimize vendor services, identify cost-saving opportunities, and align vendor performance with business goals.

Assistant Vice President, IT Service Delivery

Barclays Bank PLC | Pune, India

(Jul 2018 – Mar 2024)

- Led Global IT Service Delivery Management - managed the vendor-managed services contract, overseeing ITSM metrics, SLA relationships, escalations, license renewals, and service validation.
- Managed vendor relationships to optimize IT service delivery and compliance with contractual agreements.
- Oversaw external partner SLA performance, contractual SLAs & key vendor relationships.
- Owned software license lifecycle management, including compliance monitoring and cost optimization strategies.
- Engaged senior stakeholders, including CIOs, Product Heads, and PMOs for effective IT governance.
- Managed Change and Problem Management processes and RCA to minimize service disruptions.
- Led IT service audits (SOX, PwC, ISO 20000, ISO 27001) and ensured timely closure of audit points.

Assistant Vice President, IT Change Management

Nomura Holdings | Mumbai, India

(Dec 2014 – Jun 2018)

- Led IT Change Management, ensuring compliance with global policies and risk mitigation.
- Oversaw operational best practices in Change Mgmt. ensuring audit compliance and timely closure of audit points.
- Hosted CAB meetings to analyze risk, anticipate service disruptions & ensure compliance with company IT policies
- Partnered with business units and product owners to optimize IT service value, enhance cost-effectiveness & support budget forecasting.

Senior Change and Acceptance Manager

Fidelity International | Gurgaon, India

(Sep 2005 – Dec 2014)

- Led IT Change Management, managing technology changes and project acceptance meetings.
- Reviewed and assessed IT risk of enterprise-wide major projects with project managers, business analysts & business stakeholders prior to release.
- Held client relationship management responsibility; monitored and reviewed performance, ran weekly service reviews.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) – Bangalore University